CASE STUDY

ClassHub: turning a class parent's laptop-bound admin work into a one-touch phone app

As a class parent for a 2nd-grade class, I designed and built ClassHub, a private web app for our parent community. It replaced scattered information and hand-written emails and reminders with one place for dates, volunteer sign-ups, the class directory and announcements. Most of the communication is now automated or sent with one touch from a phone.

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Discover · Design · Build · Improve

FIRST THREE WEEKS AFTER LAUNCH

~3¾ hrs	44	55	60+
saved per week for the class parent (estimate)	people signed in, about 3 in 4 invited parents	volunteer sign-ups from 24 different parents	improvements shipped from real feedback

The problem

I'm the class parent, which is a small-operations job done in spare time. Before ClassHub, the work had two big problems:

- **Nothing was in one place.** The roster, important dates, volunteer needs and birthdays lived in different spreadsheets, forms and message threads.
- **Every email and reminder was written by hand.** That included the weekly update, volunteer reminders, birthday reminders and information for the teacher, and pulling it all together meant sitting down at a laptop.

On top of that, I spent time every week answering the same questions: "When is…?", "Where do I sign up?", "Are there spots left?"

The underlying problems were **scattered information**, **manual, repetitive communication** and **work tied to a desk**. Small businesses deal with the same problems every day.

What I did

1 Discover

Because I was doing the job myself, I started from my own week: what I re-typed, what I chased, and which questions parents kept asking. I also talked with other parents and co-admins about what they needed and what they worried about, mainly privacy for families and children.

2 Design

- **One place for everything** parents need
- **Phone-first**, used from the home-screen icon
- **Admins enter information once**; emails, reminders and the calendar feed are generated from it
- **Private by default**: only rostered families can sign in
- **Free to run** on free tiers, with no monthly bill

3 Build

A working web app with two sides.

For parents

- Upcoming dates that sync to their phone's calendar
- One-tap volunteer sign-up and cancel, with spots left and who's going
- A private class directory they can edit or hide from
- Announcements with photos, birthday-treat sign-ups and a "contact us" form
- Sign-in with a 6-digit email code, with no passwords

For class admins

- Post announcements with a photo, then email or WhatsApp one with a single tap after previewing it
- Manage the roster, dates, volunteer requests with named roles, and quick links
- Copy and repeat dates and requests weekly or monthly
- One-click or fully automatic **weekly email**
- **Automatic volunteer reminders** the day before

Built-in safeguards. Only rostered emails can create an account, and removing a family cuts off access immediately. The database itself enforces who can see and change what. Volunteer slots can't be over-filled, even if two parents grab the last spot at the same moment. Automated checks run on every change, plus an hourly site monitor.

4 Improve

After launch I kept improving it based on real use, shipping **60+ improvements** in the first few weeks, almost all prompted by parent or admin feedback. Some examples:

WHAT PARENTS AND ADMINS NEEDED	WHAT I CHANGED
Not forgetting what they'd signed up for	Automatic reminders the day before
A quick look at what's coming this week	A "Next 5 days" view on the home screen
Control over their family's contact details	Parents can edit or hide their own family
Different jobs within one event, like drivers and chaperones	Named roles inside a volunteer request
Sending one urgent announcement right away	Email or WhatsApp a single announcement, with a preview

Results

First three weeks after launch, late September to mid-October 2026.

32
families on the roster, with 58 parent and guardian emails

44
people signed in, with no training or app store

55
volunteer sign-ups from 24 parents across 39 requests

116
weekly emails delivered individually to families

71 dates and **10 announcements** were posted once and shown everywhere: in the app, the weekly email and parents' phone calendars. Volunteer reminders go out automatically the day before.

Time saved: an estimated 3 hours 45 minutes a week

~3 hrs from weekly emails, volunteer and birthday reminders, and sharing information with the teacher, which are now automated or sent with one touch

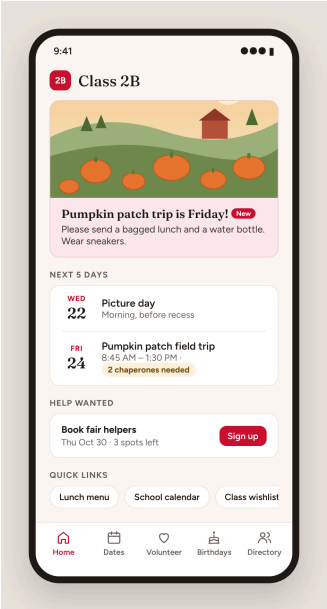
~45 min that used to go to answering parents' questions and pointing them to dates and sign-ups, which they now find themselves

Run from a phone. Directing and reminding parents now takes a few taps, where before it meant pulling everything together on a laptop. That time now goes to supporting other parts of the class community instead of admin.

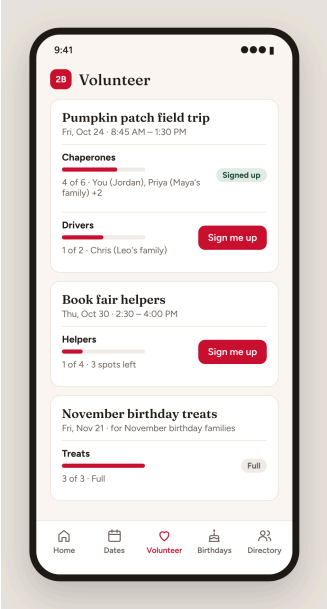
> "Just signed up using the VERY SICK [class] app. Thank you again to everyone who worked on that. It's so good and SO helpful! 🙏🙏🙏"
>
> A parent in the class, unprompted, in the class group chat

What it looks like

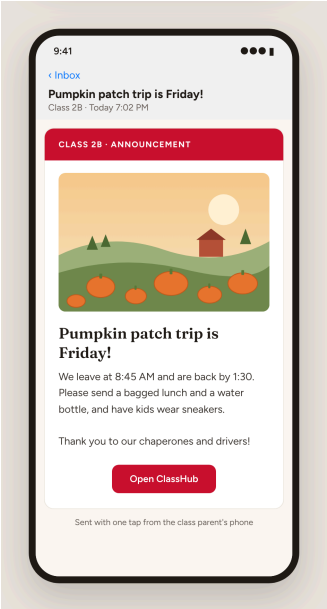
Illustrative mockups with made-up data. To protect families' privacy, no real screens or photos are shown.



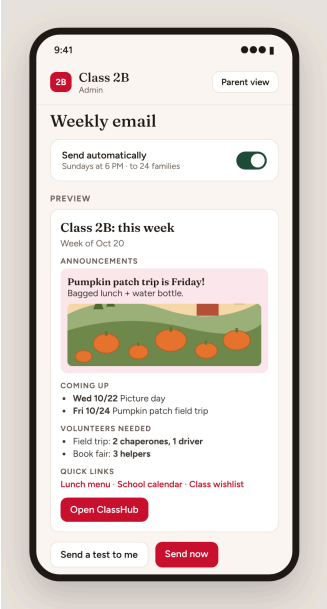
Parent home



Volunteer sign-up



One-tap announcement email



Automatic weekly email

Why this matters for a small business

ClassHub is a class parent tool, but the pattern is the one most small businesses need:

1. Find the repetitive manual work
Re-typing, chasing, reminding

2. Enter information once
Let the system generate emails, reminders and reports from it

3. Control who can see what
Privacy and permissions built in, not bolted on

4. Ship small, then improve
Based on how people actually use it

How it's built

Next.js and TypeScript on Vercel, with a Supabase (Postgres) database using row-level security for access control, Resend for email, and scheduled jobs for reminders and the weekly email. Automated tests and page checks run on every change. I built it using AI-assisted development, which is how one person delivered and kept improving a production app this quickly. The source code is private.